

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Indian Political Geography: Boundaries and Neighbours - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Indian Political Geography: Boundaries and Neighbours	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — THE CORE VOCABULARY OF POLITICAL GEOGRAPHY Evidence chain: Core political-geography vocabulary Qualified use:
02	FOUNDATION — HOW A BOUNDARY IS MADE, STAGE BY STAGE Four stages of boundary making: Boundaries are made through
03	FOUNDATION — NATURAL AND GEOMETRIC BOUNDARY TYPES Evidence chain: Natural and geometric boundary types Qualified use:
04	FOUNDATION — THE GENETIC CLASSIFICATION AND WHAT IT PREDICTS Evidence chain: Genetic classification of boundaries Qualified use:
05	CORE — FRONTIER INTERACTION AGAINST BOUNDARY SOVEREIGNTY Converting a frontier into a boundary is itself a dispute origin.
06	CORE — A TYPOLOGY OF BOUNDARY-DISPUTE CAUSES Typology of dispute causes: Boundary disputes arise from positional
07	CORE — WHY NO BOUNDARY TYPE IS INTRINSICALLY STABLE Neither type is intrinsically stable: A natural boundary is not
08	CORE — CLASSICAL GEOPOLITICAL LENSES Evidence chain: Classical geopolitical lenses Qualified use: Use each
09	CORE — WHAT THE CLASSICAL LENSES OMIT Least-cost and market-area models abstract from state policy.
10	CORE — INDIA'S DUAL CONTINENTAL AND MARITIME CHARACTER Evidence chain: India's dual strategic character Qualified use: Argue
11	CORE — INDIA'S SECTOR-BY-TERRAIN BORDER FRAMEWORK Sector-by-terrain management framework: India's boundary
12	CORE — WHY UNIFORM BORDER INSTRUMENTS FAIL Evidence chain: Why uniform instruments fail - Enclave and exchange
13	SYNTHESIS — INDIA'S NEIGHBOUR SET AND ITS ADJACENCY TYPES Evidence chain: India's neighbour set Qualified use: State adjacency
14	SYNTHESIS — HIGH-YIELD BOUNDARY LINES AND THE CATEGORY FIREWALL Evidence chain: High-yield boundary lines - Category firewall for
15	SYNTHESIS — INDIA-CHINA SECTORS, THE BANGLADESH SETTLEMENT AND FORCE Institutional mandates of the border-guarding forces, and the

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly explains Core political-geography vocabulary?

A. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical.

Answer: A. Explanation: A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q2. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Core political-geography vocabulary?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. C. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: B. Explanation: A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q3. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Core political-geography vocabulary?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. C. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

categories.

Q4. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Core political-geography vocabulary?

A. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. B. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. C. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. D. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory.

Answer: D. Explanation: A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly explains Four stages of boundary making?

A. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. B. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. C. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. D. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts.

Answer: A. Explanation: Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q6. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Four stages of boundary making?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. C. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. D. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q7. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Four stages of boundary making?

A. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. B. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q8. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Four stages of boundary making?

A. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: D. Explanation: Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly explains Delimitation-demarcation gap?

A. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. B. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: A. Explanation: Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q10. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Delimitation-demarcation gap?

A. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it

is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: B. Explanation: Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q11. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Delimitation-demarcation gap?

A. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: C. Explanation: Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q12. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Delimitation-demarcation gap?

A. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. B. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. C. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. D. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts.

Answer: D. Explanation: Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly explains Natural and geometric boundary types?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: A. Explanation: A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q14. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Natural and geometric boundary types?

A. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. B. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. C. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: B. Explanation: A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q15. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Natural and geometric boundary types?

A. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. B. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. C. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: C. Explanation: A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q16. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Natural and geometric boundary types?

A. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. B. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. C. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. D. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical.

Answer: D. Explanation: A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly explains Genetic classification of boundaries?

A. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: A. Explanation: Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q18. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Genetic classification of boundaries?

A. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. B. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. C. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. D. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources.

Answer: B. Explanation: Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q19. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Genetic classification of boundaries?

A. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. D. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law.

Answer: C. Explanation: Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q20. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Genetic classification of boundaries?

A. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: D. Explanation: Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly explains Frontier as zone, boundary as line?

A. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. D. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law.

Answer: A. Explanation: A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q22. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Frontier as zone, boundary as line?

A. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. B. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. C. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. D. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources.

Answer: B. Explanation: A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q23. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Frontier as zone, boundary as line?

A. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. B. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. C. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. D. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school.

Answer: C. Explanation: A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q24. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Frontier as zone, boundary as line?

A. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. B. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. C. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. D. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes.

Answer: D. Explanation: A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly explains Typology of dispute causes?

A. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. B. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. C. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. D. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources.

Answer: A. Explanation: Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q26. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Typology of dispute causes?

A. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. B. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. C. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. D. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q27. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Typology of dispute causes?

A. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. D. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q28. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Typology of dispute causes?

A. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. D. Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Answer: D. Explanation: Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of

the defining feature. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly explains Neither type is intrinsically stable?

A. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. D. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it.

Answer: A. Explanation: A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q30. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Neither type is intrinsically stable?

A. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. B. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. C. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. D. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it.

Answer: B. Explanation: A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q31. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Neither type is intrinsically stable?

A. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. B. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. C. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: C. Explanation: A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q32. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Neither type is intrinsically stable?

A. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. B. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. C. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. D. A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources.

Answer: D. Explanation: A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly explains Classical geopolitical lenses?

A. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. B. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. C. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. D. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q34. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Classical geopolitical lenses?

A. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. B. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. C. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. D. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q35. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Classical geopolitical lenses?

A. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. B. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. C. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: C. Explanation: Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q36. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Classical geopolitical lenses?

A. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. B. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. C. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. D. Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law.

Answer: D. Explanation: Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly explains What the classical theories omit?

A. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: A. Explanation: The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q38. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of What the classical theories omit?

A. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. B. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: B. Explanation: The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q39. Which statement preserves the process boundary for What the classical theories omit?

A. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. B. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. C. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: C. Explanation: The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q40. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning What the classical theories omit?

A. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. B. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly explains India's dual strategic character?

A. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. B. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. C. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. D. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q42. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India's dual strategic character?

A. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. B. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q43. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India's dual strategic character?

A. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. B. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. C. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. D. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q44. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India's dual strategic character?

A. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. B. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. C. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. D. India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly explains Sector-by-terrain management framework?

A. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. B. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q46. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Sector-by-terrain management framework?

A. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. B. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q47. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Sector-by-terrain management framework?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. C. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q48. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Sector-by-terrain management framework?

A. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. B. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. C. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. D. India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly explains Why uniform instruments fail?

A. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. B. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: A. Explanation: Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q50. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Why uniform instruments fail?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. C. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: B. Explanation: Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q51. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Why uniform instruments fail?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. C. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. D. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.

Answer: C. Explanation: Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q52. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Why uniform instruments fail?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Answer: D. Explanation: Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly explains Enclave and exchange logic?

A. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. B. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. C. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. D. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.

Answer: A. Explanation: An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q54. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Enclave and exchange logic?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. C. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. D. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.

Answer: B. Explanation: An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q55. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Enclave and exchange logic?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. C. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. D. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border.

Answer: C. Explanation: An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q56. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Enclave and exchange logic?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one.

Answer: D. Explanation: An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly explains India's neighbour set?

A. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. B. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. C. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. D. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier.

Answer: A. Explanation: The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q58. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India's neighbour set?

A. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. B. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. C. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: B. Explanation: The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q59. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India's neighbour set?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. C. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: C. Explanation: The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q60. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India's neighbour set?

A. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. B. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.

Answer: D. Explanation: The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree

Channel from Lakshadweep. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly explains High-yield boundary lines?

A. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. B. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q62. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of High-yield boundary lines?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q63. Which statement preserves the process boundary for High-yield boundary lines?

A. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. B. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. C. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. D. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of

Control in 1972. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q64. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning High-yield boundary lines?

A. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. B. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. C. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. D. The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly explains Category firewall for control lines?

A. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. B. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: A. Explanation: International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q66. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Category firewall for control lines?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. C. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. D. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border.

Answer: B. Explanation: International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q67. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Category firewall for control lines?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. C. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: C. Explanation: International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q68. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Category firewall for control lines?

A. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. B. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier.

Answer: D. Explanation: International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly explains India-China three-sector division?

A. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. B. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q70. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of India-China three-sector division?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. C. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q71. Which statement preserves the process boundary for India-China three-sector division?

A. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q72. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning India-China three-sector division?

A. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. B. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly explains Land Boundary Agreement chain?

A. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. B. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q74. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Land Boundary Agreement chain?

A. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. B. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. C. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. D. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q75. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Land Boundary Agreement chain?

A. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. D. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q76. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Land Boundary Agreement chain?

A. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. D. The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 1974 Land Boundary Agreement, the 2011 Protocol and the 2015 implementation with its exchange of letters on 6 June and appointed day of 31 July resolved enclaves, adverse possessions and undemarcated stretches on the India-Bangladesh alluvial border. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly explains Border-force geographic mandates?

A. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: A. Explanation: The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q78. Which option is the safest spatial interpretation of Border-force geographic mandates?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. C. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. D. Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.

Answer: B. Explanation: The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q79. Which statement preserves the process boundary for Border-force geographic mandates?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. C. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. D. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.

Answer: C. Explanation: The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

Q80. Which option avoids the main UPSC trap concerning Border-force geographic mandates?

A. A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. B. A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. C. Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. D. The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space.

Answer: D. Explanation: The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. The other options describe different processes, locations, scales or governance categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers consulted for this build assign no direct Mains PYQ to Geography Topic 35. The topic does own routed Prelims demand, including the 2018 longitude-proximity question on Indian cities, the 2020 Siachen Glacier location question, the 2022 Himalayan peak-location matching question, the 2024 west-to-east sequence of Himalayan tributaries of the Ganga and the 2026 question on state boundaries, international borders and interstate adjacency. Those entries are recorded in the ledgers as objective questions whose official keys are either unavailable locally or deliberately not inferred, so this package reproduces no option letter or answer key and fabricates no direct solved PYQ card.

CROSS-OWNER MATERIAL BOUNDARY

Legacy owner PYQ integration remains preserved inside the complete Basic or Advanced evidence banks, but it is not repeated here or presented as direct solved PYQ practice.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish boundary, frontier and borderland, and explain why frontier geography often matters more than the legal line. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The three terms describe a line of sovereignty, a zone of transition and a lived human-use space, and questions about interaction, migration, exchange and strategic depth belong to the frontier and borderland rather than to the line itself.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory.
- A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes.
- India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions.
- An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one.

Qualified conclusion: The three terms describe a line of sovereignty, a zone of transition and a lived human-use space, and questions about interaction, migration, exchange and strategic depth belong to the frontier and borderland rather than to the line itself.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Distinguish boundary, frontier and borderland, and explain why frontier geography often...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The three terms describe a line of sovereignty, a zone of transition and a lived human-use space, and questions about interaction, migration, exchange and strategic depth belong to the frontier and borderland rather than to the line itself.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A boundary is a recognised line separating the territory or jurisdiction of two states, a frontier is a wider borderland zone of transition, a borderland is the human-use space on either side of the line, an enclave is territory enclosed by another state, and an exclave is a detached part of a state separated from its main territory. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A boundary separates sovereignty as a precise line, while a frontier explains interaction, friction, migration, exchange and strategic depth as a zone, so converting a historical frontier into a modern boundary is itself a common origin of disputes. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border

ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: The three terms describe a line of sovereignty, a zone of transition and a lived human-use space, and questions about interaction, migration, exchange and strategic depth belong to the frontier and borderland rather than to the line itself.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish boundary, frontier and borderland, and explain why frontier geography often...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain how boundaries are made and why so many disputes survive the making of a boundary. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The four-stage sequence of allocation, delimitation, demarcation and administration leaves two structural weak points, since a paper line may never be marked on the ground and a defining physical feature may move after the line is drawn.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements.
- Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts.
- A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical.
- Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.

Qualified conclusion: The four-stage sequence of allocation, delimitation, demarcation and administration leaves two structural weak points, since a paper line may never be marked on the ground and a defining physical feature may move after the line is drawn.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how boundaries are made and why so many disputes survive the making of a boundary....", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The four-stage sequence of allocation, delimitation, demarcation and administration leaves two structural weak points, since a paper line may never be marked on the ground and a defining physical feature may move after the line is drawn.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Boundaries are made through allocation as a political decision, delimitation as the map and text drawing, demarcation as physical marking on the ground, and administration through check posts, patrols, crossings and settlements. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Many disputes persist because delimitation exists on paper while demarcation on the ground is incomplete, or because a river or channel used as the defining feature later shifts. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A natural or physical boundary follows a mountain, river, watershed, desert or sea, while an artificial or geometric boundary follows a straight or coordinate-based line, and straight-line boundaries are usually more political than physical. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: The four-stage sequence of allocation, delimitation, demarcation and administration leaves two structural weak points, since a paper line may never be marked on the ground and a defining physical feature may move after the line is drawn.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain how boundaries are made and why so many disputes survive the making of a boundary...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the genetic classification of boundaries and show how boundary genesis predicts the type of dispute that follows. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Classifying a boundary as antecedent, subsequent, superimposed or relict states when it was drawn relative to the human landscape, and that timing predicts whether the resulting dispute is positional, territorial, functional or a legacy effect.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows.
- Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature.
- A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources.
- Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

Qualified conclusion: Classifying a boundary as antecedent, subsequent, superimposed or relict states when it was drawn relative to the human landscape, and that timing predicts whether the resulting dispute is positional, territorial, functional or a legacy effect.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the genetic classification of boundaries and show how boundary genesis predicts the...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Classifying a boundary as antecedent, subsequent, superimposed or relict states when it was drawn relative to the human landscape, and that timing predicts whether the resulting dispute is positional, territorial, functional or a legacy effect.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Antecedent, subsequent, superimposed and relict is a genetic classification that sorts boundaries by when they were drawn relative to the human landscape, and it is that timing which predicts the kind of dispute that follows. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Boundary disputes arise from positional disagreement about where an agreed line runs, territorial disagreement about who owns a defined area, resource or functional contest over use across the line, antecedent and superimposed line problems, relict boundary effects and geomorphic instability of the defining feature. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** A natural boundary is not automatically more peaceful than a geometric one, because a river migrates and is hard to demarcate while a straight line divides communities and resources. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Classifying a boundary as antecedent, subsequent, superimposed or relict states when it was drawn relative to the human landscape, and that timing predicts whether the resulting dispute is positional, territorial, functional or a legacy effect.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine the genetic classification of boundaries and show how boundary genesis predicts the...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the relevance and the limitations of the Heartland, Rimland and Sea Power arguments for contemporary geography. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Each classical lens isolates a genuine spatial variable in interior depth, coastal transition and maritime access, but each omits domains that now shape strategy, so the arguments frame a question without settling it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law.
- The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it.
- India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school.
- International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier.

Qualified conclusion: Each classical lens isolates a genuine spatial variable in interior depth, coastal transition and maritime access, but each omits domains that now shape strategy, so the arguments frame a question without settling it.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the relevance and the limitations of the Heartland, Rimland and Sea Power arguments...”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Each classical lens isolates a genuine spatial variable in interior depth, coastal transition and maritime access, but each omits domains that now shape strategy, so the arguments frame a question without settling it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Mackinder's Heartland argument on Eurasian interior depth, Spykman's Rimland argument on coastal margins and Mahan's Sea Power argument on naval access and sea lanes are historical lenses, each identifying a genuine spatial variable rather than a predictive law. **Analysis:** Connect the named

place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain.

Qualification: State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The classical lenses omit air and space power, cyber and submarine-cable infrastructure, economic interdependence, non-state actors and nuclear deterrence, which together mean geography conditions strategy without determining it. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** India's position is genuinely dual: a continental frontier requiring mountain and plains defence, and a peninsular maritime position astride major sea lanes with island territories extending its maritime reach, and recognising that duality is stronger than assigning India to any one school. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: Each classical lens isolates a genuine spatial variable in interior depth, coastal transition and maritime access, but each omits domains that now shape strategy, so the arguments frame a question without settling it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the relevance and the limitations of the Heartland, Rimland and Sea Power arguments...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Discuss the challenges of managing India's land and maritime borders and explain why uniform instruments cannot secure them all. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: India's borders present several distinct geographic problems set by terrain, settlement density and the legal clarity of the line, so differentiated management combining infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration outperforms uniform hardening.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions.
- Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors.

- An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one.
- The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space.

Qualified conclusion: India's borders present several distinct geographic problems set by terrain, settlement density and the legal clarity of the line, so differentiated management combining infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration outperforms uniform hardening.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the challenges of managing India's land and maritime borders and explain why uniform...", all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India's borders present several distinct geographic problems set by terrain, settlement density and the legal clarity of the line, so differentiated management combining infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration outperforms uniform hardening.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** India's boundary management differs by terrain: high-altitude glaciated sectors face inaccessibility and watershed ambiguity, densely populated plains sectors face smuggling and divided fields, riverine and deltaic sectors face migrating channels and shifting char lands, forested hill sectors face cross-border ethnic continuity, desert sectors face surveillance over long distances with shifting markers, and the maritime boundary raises zone delimitation, island baselines and fishing questions. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Because India's border problem is several problems differing by terrain, settlement density, legal status of the line and the nature of cross-border activity, uniform instruments such as blanket fencing or a single force posture cannot fit all sectors. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** An enclave leaves residents cut off from their own state's administration, services and law enforcement, which is why enclave exchange is the standard remedy and why this is a geographic problem before it is a diplomatic one. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The geographic mandates are the Border Security Force on the India-Pakistan and India-Bangladesh borders, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police on the India-China frontier, the Sashastra Seema Bal on the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, the Assam Rifles on the India-Myanmar border and the Indian Coast Guard in the maritime surveillance space. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: India's borders present several distinct geographic problems set by terrain, settlement density and the legal clarity of the line, so differentiated management combining infrastructure, surveillance and local economic integration outperforms uniform hardening.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For “Discuss the challenges of managing India's land and maritime borders and explain why uniform...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse how India's boundary lines and neighbour geography require different analytical categories rather than a single border narrative. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: India's northern high-mountain frontier, its plains and deltaic land boundaries and its maritime neighbourhood are governed by different legal categories and terrain logics, so accurate answers separate international boundary, control line and undemarcated frontier before arguing.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep.
- The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972.
- International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier.
- The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies.

Qualified conclusion: India's northern high-mountain frontier, its plains and deltaic land boundaries and its maritime neighbourhood are governed by different legal categories and terrain logics, so accurate answers separate international boundary, control line and undemarcated frontier before arguing.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse how India's boundary lines and neighbour geography require different analytical...”, all clauses and scales, a causal-spatial argument, named India/world evidence, model or policy limits and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: India's northern high-mountain frontier, its plains and deltaic land boundaries and its maritime neighbourhood are governed by different legal categories and terrain logics, so accurate answers separate international boundary, control line and undemarcated frontier before arguing.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The source text treats India as sharing boundaries with Afghanistan through its claimed far north-west position, Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh, while Sri Lanka lies across the Palk Strait and Gulf of Mannar and the Maldives is the atoll neighbour across the Eight Degree Channel from Lakshadweep. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Radcliffe Line of 1947 framed the partition boundary with Pakistan, the McMahon Line of the 1914 framework concerns the eastern India-China sector, the Durand Line of 1893 is the Afghanistan-Pakistan line rather than an India-Pakistan line, and the 1949 Ceasefire Line became the Line of Control in 1972. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** International Boundary, the Line of Control and the Line of Actual Control are not interchangeable categories, because the first defines sovereignty, the second is a military control line and the third is a control reality over an undemarcated high-mountain frontier. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-China boundary is divided into a western sector in the Ladakh, Karakoram and Aksai Chin space, a middle sector along the Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand frontier, and an eastern sector along the Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh frontier where the McMahon Line chiefly applies. **Analysis:** Connect the named place, dataset, model or institution to the driver -> mechanism -> spatial pattern -> consequence chain. **Qualification:** State the scale, model assumption, interacting control, regional exception or source-date-status boundary.

Counter-position / limit: A spatial correlation, model prediction, single scheme or aggregate statistic is neither a sufficient cause nor a timeless description; test institutions, agency, networks, scale, distributional effects and the evidence date.

Qualified conclusion: India's northern high-mountain frontier, its plains and deltaic land boundaries and its maritime neighbourhood are governed by different legal categories and terrain logics, so accurate answers separate international boundary, control line and undemarcated frontier before arguing.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding and drawing the map/flow; open with definition and thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for the scale, model or data-status limit.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains spatial differentiation, integrates Indian evidence and avoids determinism or timeless statistics.

How to improve this answer: For "Analyse how India's boundary lines and neighbour geography require different analytical...", replace the weakest generalisation with one labelled map, model assumption, policy chronology or dataset and state the exception, scale or source-date-status boundary.